

AVC (3017.TW): Rising liquid cooling penetration rate and VC in smartphones drive growth ahead; 4Q25 in line; Buy

AVC's 4Q25 revenue and GM are in line with our estimate and Bloomberg consensus, and the opex ratio of 5.8% is better than our estimate, leading 4Q25 OP income to grow at +191% YoY, or 6% ahead of our estimates. We are positive on AVC's earnings growth, supported by (1) shipments growth of GPU and ASIC AI servers, along with the rising liquid cooling penetration rate, driving AVC's liquid cooling components shipments growth, (2) increasing adoption rate of ultra-thin VC in consumer electronics to fit the lightweight design and major customer's foldable phone model launch in 2H26 support AVC's smartphone liquid cooling revenue growth, (3) rising contribution from AI server liquid cooling components supporting the GM improvement. Maintain Buy with 12M TP raised to NT\$2,259 (21.2x 2027E P/E vs. +23% NI YoY on avg. in 2027-28E).

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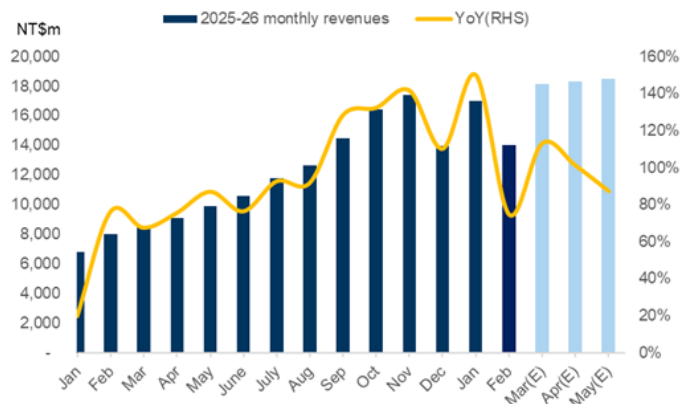
Exhibit 1: AVC 4Q25 result snapshot

NT\$m	4Q24	3Q25	4Q25	QoQ	YoY	GS	Act / GS	Cons.	Act / Cons.
Revenues	20,904	38,937	47,775	23%	129%	47,775	0%	47,756	0%
GP	5,224	10,172	12,610	24%	141%	12,362	2%	12,709	-1%
OP	3,384	8,179	9,852	20%	191%	9,304	6%		
Net income	2,338	5,339	6,636	24%	184%	6,633	0%	6,409	4%
Margins									
GM	25.0%	26.1%	26.4%			25.9%		26.6%	
OPM	16.2%	21.0%	20.6%			19.5%		0.0%	
NM	11.2%	13.7%	13.9%			13.9%		13.4%	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

3-month revenue preview: AVC's Feb revenues declined by 18% MoM, or 9% behind our estimates, due to less working days under Chinese New Year, and consumer electronics entering slow season. In coming months, we expect sequential increase to continue through 2026E, riding on rack-level AI servers ramp up driving liquid cooling penetration rate, and we continue to expect higher revenues contribution in 2H26 vs. 1H26 driven by (1) more new AI servers racks launch, (2) ASIC AI servers new models launch with higher liquid cooling penetration rate, (3) rising VC adoption rate in smartphones, along with growing foldable phones.

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Exhibit 2: AVC monthly revenue trend

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: AVC monthly/quarterly revenue summary

	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26E	Apr-26E	May-26E	Jun-26E	1Q26E	2Q26E
Rev (NT\$m)	17,003	14,017	18,142	18,323	18,506	18,922	49,162	55,751
Rev YoY	150%	75%	113%	101%	87%	78%	111%	88%
Rev MoM / QoQ	22%	-18%	29%	1%	1%	2%	3%	13%
GS estimates (NT\$m)	13,941	15,473						
Act vs. GS	22%	-9%						

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Earnings revision: We factor in AVC's 4Q25 result and revise up our 2026-28E revenues up by 5% / 7% / 7%, mainly on higher AI server liquid cooling components shipments estimates, reflecting our positive view on AVC benefiting from the rising liquid cooling penetration rate in both GPU and ASIC AI servers. Our 2026-28E GMs are slightly revised up, mainly driven by the rising contribution from AI server liquid cooling components. We revise down our 2026-28E opex ratios to reflect the company's improving operational efficiency as shipments ramp up, leading our 2026-28E net incomes up 8% / 10% / 11%.

Exhibit 4: Earnings revision

NT\$m	2025			2026E			2027E			2028E		
	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %
Revenues	139,639	139,639	0%	208,328	219,296	5%	243,145	259,300	7%	277,389	295,743	7%
GP	35,786	36,034	1%	56,769	60,103	6%	67,840	73,121	8%	79,059	85,219	8%
OP	27,008	27,556	2%	42,913	46,430	8%	53,787	58,989	10%	62,970	69,841	11%
Net income	19,183	19,186	0%	30,746	33,283	8%	38,603	42,502	10%	45,317	50,294	11%
Margins												
GM	25.6%	25.8%		27.2%	27.4%		27.9%	28.2%		28.5%	28.8%	
OPM	19.3%	19.7%		20.6%	21.2%		22.1%	22.7%		22.7%	23.6%	
NM	13.7%	13.7%		14.8%	15.2%		15.9%	16.4%		16.3%	17.0%	

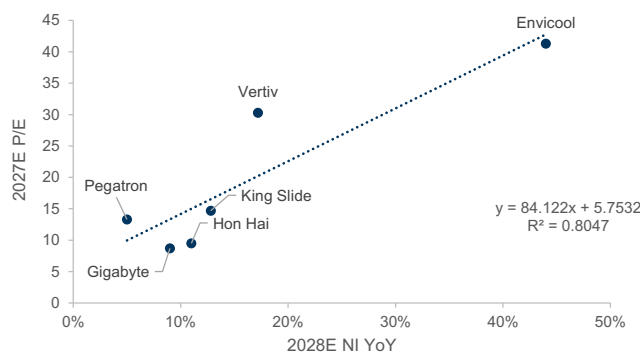
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: AVC P&L summary

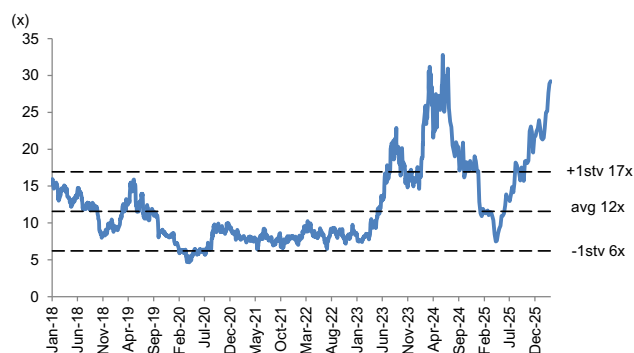
NTD mn	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26E	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E
Income statement														
Revenue	59,194	71,761	139,639	219,296	259,300	295,743	23,333	29,595	38,937	47,775	49,162	55,751	56,059	58,323
Gross profit	12,388	16,870	36,034	60,103	73,121	85,219	6,028	7,224	10,172	12,610	12,872	14,718	15,842	16,671
Opex	(4,921)	(5,993)	(8,478)	(13,673)	(14,132)	(15,379)	(1,682)	(2,045)	(1,993)	(2,758)	(3,245)	(3,680)	(3,308)	(3,441)
OP income	7,467	10,878	27,556	46,430	58,989	69,841	4,346	5,180	8,179	9,852	9,627	11,038	12,534	13,230
Net income	5,305	8,172	19,186	33,283	42,502	50,294	3,214	3,997	5,339	6,636	6,895	7,911	8,988	9,489
EPS (NTD, diluted)	13.71	20.62	48.10	83.44	106.55	126.08	8.06	10.02	13.39	16.64	17.29	19.83	22.53	23.79
Margins														
Gross margin	20.9%	23.5%	25.8%	27.4%	28.2%	28.8%	25.8%	24.4%	26.1%	26.4%	26.2%	26.4%	28.3%	28.6%
Operating margin	12.6%	15.2%	19.7%	21.2%	22.7%	23.6%	18.6%	17.5%	21.0%	20.6%	19.6%	19.8%	22.4%	22.7%
Net margin	9.0%	11.4%	13.7%	15.2%	16.4%	17.0%	13.8%	13.5%	13.7%	13.9%	14.0%	14.2%	16.0%	16.3%
Ratios														
Opex ratio	-8%	-8%	-6%	-6%	-5%	-5%	-7%	-7%	-5%	-6%	-7%	-7%	-6%	-6%
Tax rate	28%	26%	27%	28%	28%	28%	24%	28%	28%	28%	28%	28%	28%	28%
YoY														
Revenue	6%	21%	95%	57%	18%	14%	52%	80%	104%	129%	111%	88%	44%	22%
Gross profit	14%	36%	114%	67%	22%	17%	79%	90%	127%	141%	114%	104%	56%	32%
OP income	18%	46%	153%	68%	27%	18%	126%	113%	160%	191%	122%	113%	53%	34%
Net income	27%	54%	135%	73%	28%	18%	105%	105%	130%	184%	115%	98%	68%	43%
QoQ														
Revenue							12%	27%	32%	23%	3%	13%	1%	4%
Gross profit							15%	20%	41%	24%	2%	14%	8%	5%
OP income							28%	19%	58%	20%	-2%	15%	14%	6%
Net income							37%	24%	34%	24%	4%	15%	14%	6%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation: We roll over our base year to 2027E (vs. 2026E previously) and continue to use the near term P/E to derive our 12M TP. We refresh the PC/server peers' EPS growth vs. P/E multiple correlation and derive our target P/E of 21.2x 2027E EPS (vs. TP implied 2027E P/E at 20.5x previously). With the updated target P/E and earnings estimates, our 12M TP is raised to NT\$2,259 (vs. NT\$1,982 previously). **Maintain Buy.**

Exhibit 6: AVC peers: EPS growth vs. P/E multiple correlation

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Refinitiv Eikon

Exhibit 7: AVC 12m forward P/E

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Refinitiv Eikon

Price Target Risks and Methodology - AVC

Our 12m target price for AVC is based on a near-term P/E, consistent with our Taiwan Technology coverage. We base our 12-m **TP of NT\$2,259** on a target P/E multiple of **21.2x** on our forward year EPS (2027E). Our target P/E is derived from the correlation between P/E and EPS growth of its peers in technology hardware. Key risks: (1) slower-than-expected adoption of liquid cooling; (2) lower-than-expected demand for AI servers; (3) fiercer-than-expected competition; (4) slower-than-expected recovery of general servers.

3017.TW	12m Price Target: NT\$2,259.00	Price: NT\$1,865.00	Upside: 21.1%			
Buy	GS Forecast					
	Market cap: NT\$718.6bn / \$22.5bn	Revenue (NT\$ mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Enterprise value: NT\$685.4bn / \$21.4bn	Revenue (NT\$ mn) Old	139,639.4	219,295.6	259,300.2	295,743.3
	3m ADTV: NT\$9.0bn / \$284.6mn	EBITDA (NT\$ mn)	30,789.9	50,142.5	64,148.9	76,731.1
	Taiwan	EPS (NT\$) New	48.10	83.44	106.55	126.08
	Greater China Technology	EPS (NT\$) Old	48.09	77.08	96.78	113.61
	M&A Rank: 3	P/E (X)	18.0	22.4	17.5	14.8
	Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	P/B (X)	8.9	13.2	9.4	7.1
		Dividend yield (%)	2.6	2.1	2.7	3.2
		CROCI (%)	77.4	93.9	97.3	91.5
			12/25	3/26E	6/26E	9/26E
		EPS (NT\$)	16.64	17.29	19.83	22.53

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 13 Mar 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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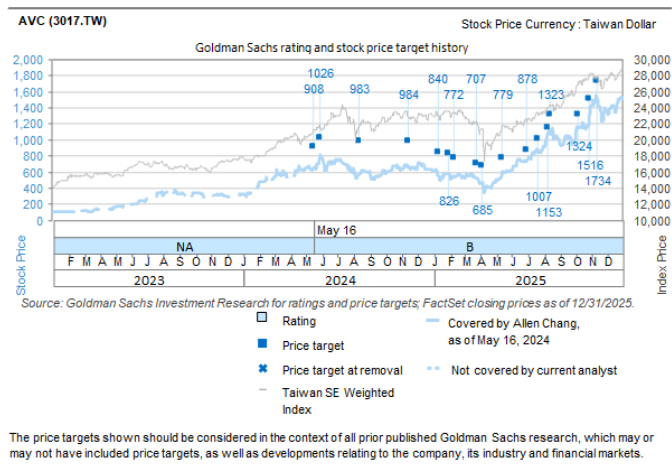
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